

Email Client Testing Findings

COMP 584 · Project 1 Email Campaign · Northstar Travel "Fall Weekend Escapes"

1. What was tested

The campaign email ([index.html](#)) has these features, and each one was checked in every view:

- **Two-column component:** "Featured stays" cards.
- **Three-column component:** "Trending this fall" destinations.
- **Responsive layout:** columns stack under 620px and text sizes shrink.
- **Interactivity:** hover states on buttons, nav links, text links, footer links and card images.
- **Keyframe animations:** flying plane (translate + rotate), wiggling promo badge (rotate), glowing button (background-color + box-shadow), sliding color stripe (background-position), sliding panel (translateY). No opacity or scale.
- **Checked-box technique:** "Find your vibe" tabs built from radio buttons, labels and divs.

2. Resource tools used

Tool	How it was used	Pros / cons
Mailtrap	Sent the HTML email to my Gmail inbox and previewed it at mobile width.	Free and quick to set up. Test emails arrive from a Mailtrap demo address.
Putsmail	First choice for sending test emails.	No longer working, so I switched to Mailtrap.
Chrome	Checked the layout at desktop and phone widths before sending.	Fast and free. It supports every feature, so it only shows the best case.
caniemail.com	Looked up expected support for each CSS feature.	Detailed per-client tables. Data can lag behind client updates.

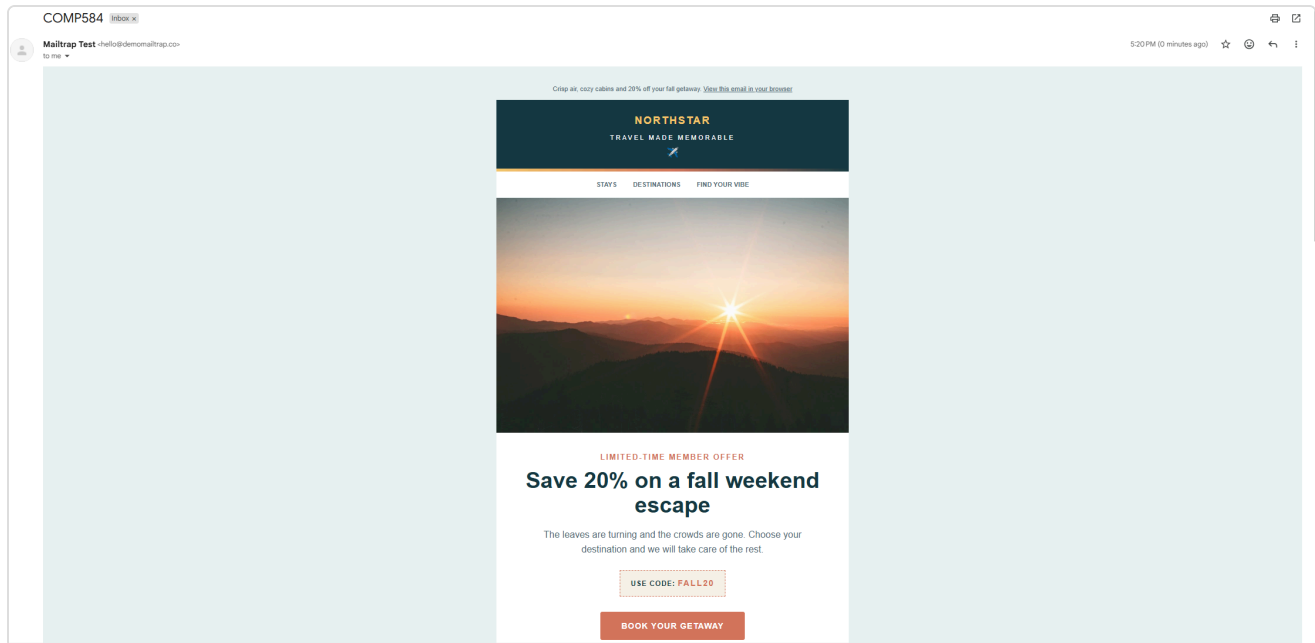
3. Results

Feature	Gmail (desktop web)	Mobile-width view	Chrome (baseline)
Two-column component	Worked: side by side	Worked: stacked	Worked
Three-column component	Worked: side by side	Worked: stacked	Worked
Text size adjusts on mobile	N/A (desktop)	Worked: headline and body text resized, nav wrapped	Worked
Hover effects	Not captured	Worked: Banff card lifted and tilted with a shadow	Worked
Keyframe animations	Did not appear: plane sat still in the center and was swapped for Gmail's emoji image; button had no glow	Worked: plane mid-flight, glow around the button	Worked
Radio-button tabs	Fallback: tabs removed, all three panels shown stacked	Worked: tabs shown, "Mountains" selected, one panel visible	Worked
Background image section	Worked	Worked	Worked

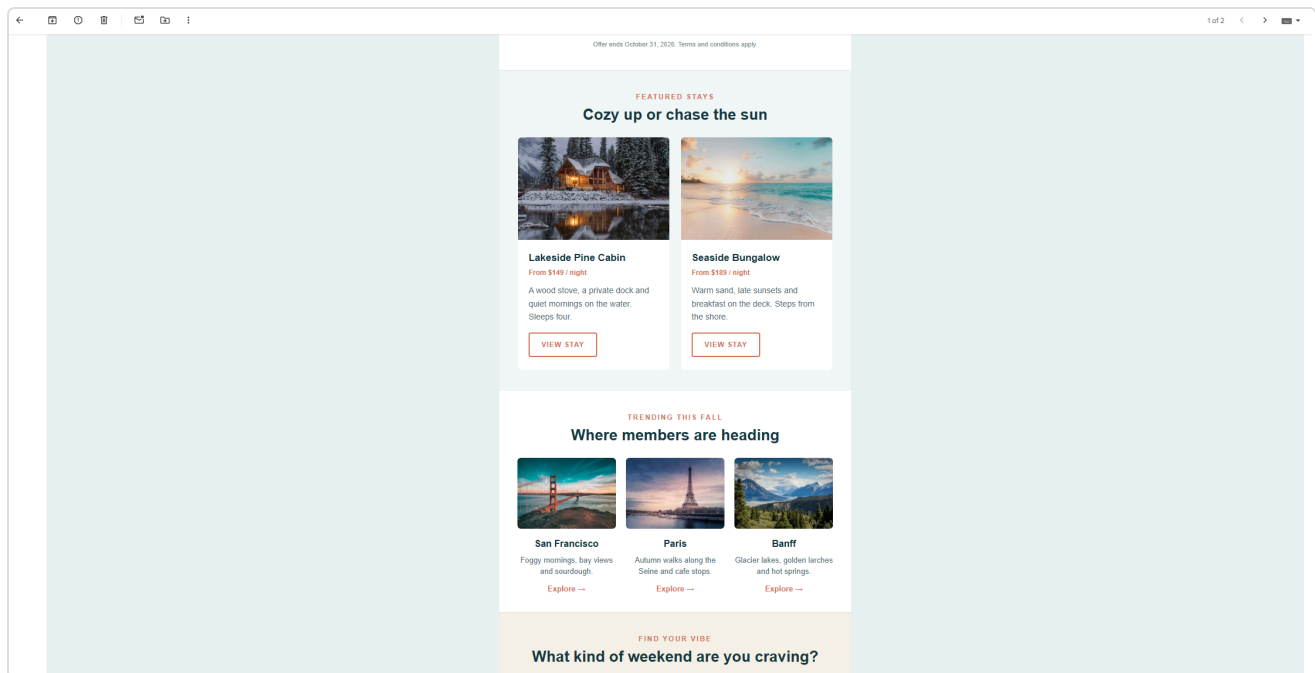
4. Screenshots

Gmail (desktop web)

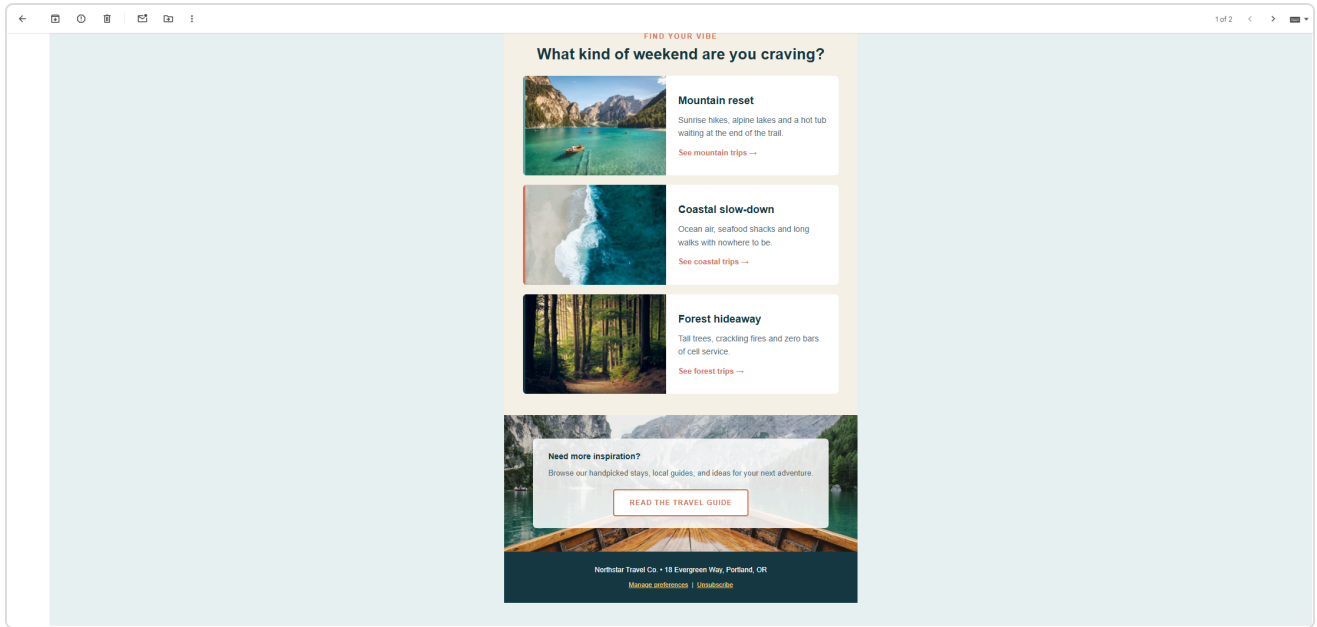
Received from Mailtrap in the Gmail inbox.



Header, hero and offer. Gmail replaced the plane with its own emoji image, and it did not move.

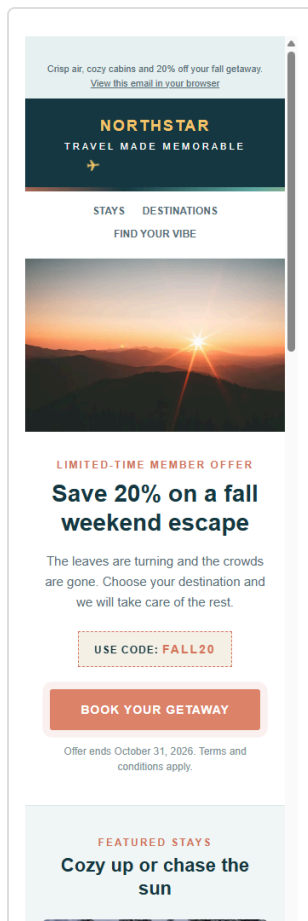


The two-column and three-column components display side by side.

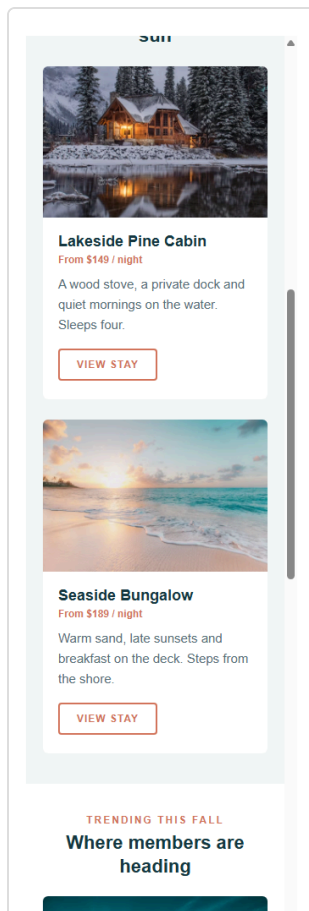


Gmail strips the radio inputs, so the tabs are hidden and all three panels show. Nothing is lost.

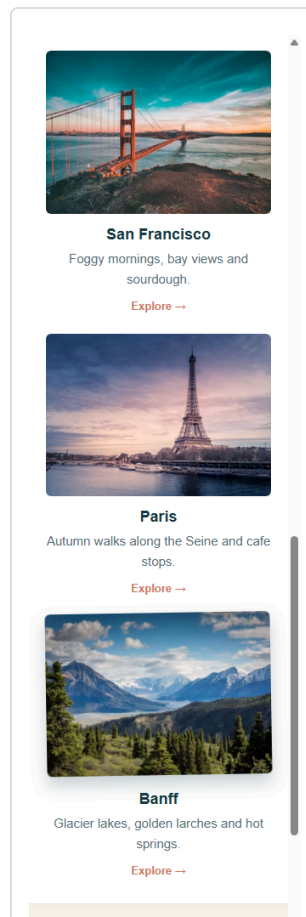
Mobile-width view



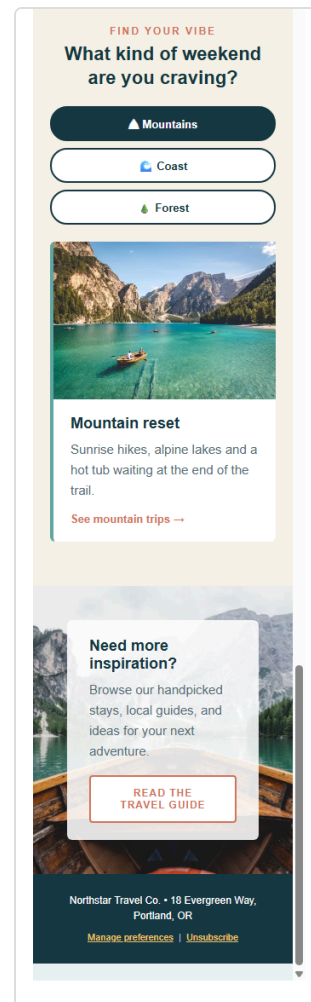
Text resized, nav wrapped, button glowing.



Two-column stays stacked.



Three-column destinations stacked. Banff card shows hover.



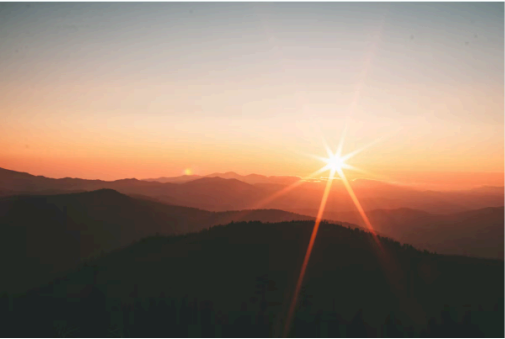
Radio tabs work. Mountains is selected.

Chrome baseline

Crisp air, cozy cabins and 20% off your fall getaway. [View this email in your browser](#)

NORTHSTAR
TRAVEL MADE MEMORABLE

STAYSDESTINATIONSFIND YOUR VIBE



LIMITED-TIME MEMBER OFFER

Save 20% on a fall weekend escape

The leaves are turning and the crowds are gone. Choose your destination and we will take care of the rest.

USE CODE: **FALL20**

BOOK YOUR GETAWAY

Offer ends October 31, 2026. Terms and conditions apply.

FEATURED STAYS

Cozy up or chase the sun



Lakeside Pine Cabin
From \$149 / night

A wood stove, a private dock and quiet mornings on the water. Sleeps four.

VIEW STAY



Seaside Bungalow
From \$189 / night

Warm sand, late sunsets and breakfast on the deck. Steps from the shore.

VIEW STAY

TRENDING THIS FALL

Where members are heading



San Francisco
Foggy mornings, bay views and sourdough.
[Explore →](#)



Paris
Autumn walks along the Seine and cafe stops.
[Explore →](#)



Banff
Glacier lakes, golden larches and hot springs.
[Explore →](#)

FIND YOUR VIBE

What kind of weekend are you craving?

Mountains

Coast

Forest



Mountain reset
Sunrise hikes, alpine lakes and a hot tub waiting at the end of the trail.
[See mountain trips →](#)

EXPLORE →

FIND YOUR VIBE

What kind of weekend are you craving?

Mountains

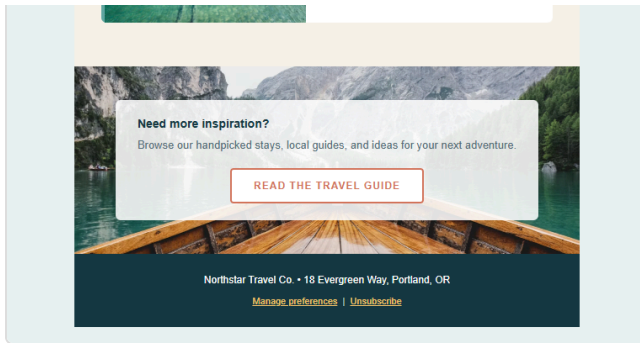
Coast

Forest



Coastal slow-down
Ocean air, seafood shacks and long walks with nowhere to be.
[See coastal trips →](#)

Clicking "Coast" shows only the coast panel.



Desktop width, every feature supported.

5. What worked and what didn't

WORKED

- Table-based two- and three-column layouts held up in every view.
- Columns stacked and text resized at mobile width.
- The background image section and outlined buttons rendered the same everywhere.
- Where the radio technique is supported, the tabs switched panels correctly.

DIDN'T WORK

- Gmail showed no keyframe animations. The plane stayed still and the button had no glow.
- Gmail removed the radio inputs, so the interactive tabs never appeared.
- Gmail swapped the plane character for its own emoji image, which changed its color.

6. Takeaways

- Gmail is the most restrictive client tested. It keeps the layout but drops animation and form-based interactivity.
- Building the interactive parts as progressive enhancements paid off. Gmail readers still see all three trip ideas, just without tabs.
- Layout features are safe to rely on. Animation and interactivity should be treated as a bonus for clients that support them.